

6

TRACK A · AI FOUNDATIONS · KIT 6 OF 20

AI for Communication: Parent Messages and Tone

Word-for-Word Facilitator Script: read it aloud exactly as written, or make it your own. Keyed to all 30 slides, with stage directions, a running clock, and answers to the questions staff actually ask.

Facilitator Script · 45–60 minutes

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi

A husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom. Adam is a certified CTE Carpentry teacher; Katelyn is a certified K-8 teacher.

How to use this script

Everything in plain type is meant to be spoken aloud. Read it verbatim (it's written for the ear) or glance and paraphrase once you're comfortable. Either way delivers a complete session. Slide cues, stage directions, and question boxes work exactly as they did in Kits 1 through 5. Run Kits 1 and 2 before this one: today leans on Kit 1's privacy rules and Kit 2's prompt formula and voice round.

Meet Ms. Rivera. Throughout the deck you'll see the same example teacher's screen: Ms. Rivera, our running composite (not a real person; she appears in every kit). When her screen is up, point the room at it; it's the model to mimic in the lab. If someone asks who she is, say exactly that: a fictional teacher we use across the series so you always see what the work looks like before you try it yourself. Her tracker chip sits top-right on every slide; the matching line under each slide cue below tells you what it says, so you always know what the room is reading.

THE STANCE OF THIS WHOLE SESSION

AI drafts the message; you make it yours. Families hear you, not the tool. Every message is reviewed and personalized before it sends, and hard news is never delivered by a draft: you call.

Timing checkpoints

Clock	You should be...	If behind...
0:12	Starting the makeovers (slide 9)	Trim discussion on slides 5–7
0:24	On the tone-repair kit (slide 13)	Never trim slides 15–16; trim slide 12 instead
0:31	Starting the lab (slide 18)	Start it anyway; the lab is the session
0:56	On First 48 Hours (slide 28)	Hold the closing lines; hand out sheets at the door

45-minute version: run two diagnosis calls on slide 12 instead of four, walk one repair on slide 14 instead of three, give lab step 1 five minutes and fold step 4 into step 2 (one read-aloud fixes voice and order together), take two share-out voices, and read the "45-min cut" stage notes where they appear.

From the founders

→ This note is from Adam and Katelyn Spinozzi, the two certified teachers who wrote this kit. It's here to give you their perspective before you present. Sharing it is entirely your call: read parts aloud where they fit, retell them in your own words, or keep it to yourself as background. The session is complete either way.

We're Adam and Katelyn, and here is why this session matters for what happens in your classrooms: family communication is where trust is built or lost, and it lives almost entirely in teachers' unpaid margins. The research is blunt about the stakes: even one personal sentence home per week measurably changes what happens for kids. But the messages that matter most are the ones teachers have the least time to write, and the ones that go out tired, rushed, or angry are the ones that cost the most. AI can buy that time back, on one condition: the voice that comes through it stays yours.

The lessons we believe this hour will leave with your staff: how to draft family messages in minutes instead of evenings and still sound like themselves; how to make the positive note home a weekly habit instead of a good intention; how to write in plain language so every family can actually use the message; how to repair the tone of a hard message before it costs a relationship; and the line that keeps all of it human, that hard news is delivered by a person, by voice, every time. Trust is built one reviewed, personal message at a time. This hour buys the time; the trust stays yours to earn.

Segment 1 · Welcome & why messages matter (slides 1–4)

SLIDE 1 Title

0:00

→ Slide 1 up as people arrive. Start on time.

Welcome back. Today is about the part of teaching nobody trained us for and everybody gets judged on: what we send home. Newsletters, updates, the email you rewrite four times because the first three sounded wrong. By the end of this hour, next week's real message will be drafted, sounding like you, and scheduled to send; you'll have a positive-note habit ready to start; and the message itself will be written plainly enough that every family on your roster can actually use it. That's the hour.

SLIDE 2 The margin problem

0:01

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her math: one wave of messages a week, drafted in the margins after dinner.

First the honest picture. Teachers work about 54 hours a week, and less than half of it is direct teaching; the rest is where communication lives, usually in the after-dinner margins. And teachers who've made AI a weekly habit report saving nearly six hours a week, with drafting communication among the most common uses. So the time is real and recoverable. The question of this session is how to recover it without families noticing a robot moved in.

SLIDE 3 One sentence moves the needle

0:03

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lever: one sentence home per week moved real outcomes. She wants that at scale.

Now the reason this hour matters beyond your inbox. In a field experiment, Harvard researchers Kraft and Rogers had teachers send one individualized sentence home per week in a summer program for students retaking a course they had failed. One sentence. The share of students failing to earn the credit fell from about 16 percent to about 9 percent, a 41 percent reduction, and the biggest effects came from messages about what the student could improve. One personal sentence, once a week. The barrier was never that teachers didn't care; it was that personal-at-scale cost hours nobody had. That's exactly the cost AI just changed.

SLIDE 4 Agenda + one promise

0:04

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her goal: next week's newsletter from blank page to scheduled send, and the batch habit started.

The hour: what AI is genuinely good at in family communication and the one thing it threatens, your voice. Then three makeovers on Ms. Rivera's screen: the newsletter, the difficult email, and the positive-note batch. Then the tone-repair kit and the lines that never move. Then the lab: you take the one real message you owe families this week from blank page to scheduled send: drafted, voiced, the hard sentence repaired, action items on top. That's the promise: you leave with a real message ready to send, not notes about messages.

Segment 2 · The tool and the voice (slides 5–8)

SLIDE 5 What it's good at here

0:05

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her shortlist: newsletters, updates, tone repair, reading level, reformatting.

Where the intern earns its keep in communication: first drafts of anything routine, newsletters, updates, reminders; repairing tone when you're too tired or too angry to find it yourself; adjusting reading level so a message lands for every family; and reformatting, the same update as an email, a text blurb, and a printable flyer. Notice what's not on the list: anything that requires knowing the family. That part was never draftable.

SLIDE 6 The voice problem

0:07

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her worry, named: if every note sounds like every other note, families notice.

Now the threat, named honestly. AI output has a house style: smooth, pleasant, beige. In a lesson plan, beige is fine. In a message to a family who knows you, beige is noticeable, and across a school it compounds: if every teacher's newsletter sounds like the same cheerful robot, families stop reading all of them. Your voice, the slightly imperfect, recognizable, human one, is not a flaw to polish out. It's the asset. Kit 2's voice round is about to become the most important skill in this session.

SLIDE 7 The two rules ride along

0:09

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her two rules, still on: the situation, never the child; nothing goes out unread.

The permanent rules, pointed at communication. Rule one, from Kit 1: no student personally identifiable information in a public AI tool, and family communication is where the temptation is strongest, because the message IS about a specific child. The move is the same as always: describe the situation to the tool, "a middle schooler with several missing assignments," and add the name after the draft is back in your own email. Rule two: nothing AI-drafted reaches a family unread. Your name is on it; a family can't tell what you wrote from what you approved, and they shouldn't have to.

SLIDE 8 The banner

0:11

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her banner: families hear HER, not the tool.

So here's the banner over everything today: families hear you, not the tool. AI drafts; you review, personalize, and send. If a message wouldn't survive you reading it aloud in your own voice at a conference, it isn't done. Hold that; every technique in the next twenty minutes serves it.

Segment 3 · Three makeovers (slides 9–12)

SLIDE 9 Makeover #1: the newsletter

0:12

Makeover one, on Ms. Rivera's screen, and count the four parts with me: role in teal, a warm, organized teacher. Task in navy: this week's family newsletter. Context in amber, and look how much she gives it: the fractions unit wrapped, science fair Thursday at six in the gym, picture day Friday, blue permission slip due Wednesday. Format in green: under 150 words, skimmable on a phone, action items bulleted, one positive line about the class's week. That's Kit 2's formula doing family work. Ninety seconds of typing, and the draft comes back needing only her voice pass.

SLIDE 10 Makeover #2: the difficult email

0:15

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her difficult email: vent draft deleted, professional draft sent, relationship intact.

Makeover two: the email you shouldn't send. A parent emails something unfair at 9 p.m. and your first draft is honest in exactly the way careers end. Here's the move: let the tool absorb the heat. Describe the situation, no names: "Draft a calm, professional reply to a frustrated parent who believes their child's grade is unfair. Acknowledge the frustration, explain that specifics belong in a conversation, offer two meeting times, keep it under 120 words, firm and warm." The draft comes back with the emotion out and the relationship intact. You add the specifics in your own email, where names are safe. And the companion habit, the 24-hour rule: if the message made you angry, the reply waits a day unless safety can't. No AI needed for that one; it's just wisdom with a timestamp.

SLIDE 11 **Makeover #3: the positive-note batch**

0:18

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her batch: three one-sentence positive notes, each personalized before sending.

Makeover three is the Kraft and Rogers finding turned into a habit. The highest-leverage message in the research is one individualized sentence, and the version focused on what a student can improve moved outcomes most. So: the batch. Once a week, ask the tool for a page of one-sentence note starters, improvement-focused and warm, organized by situation: "showed persistence on a hard problem," "helped a classmate unprompted," "turned a rough Monday around." No names anywhere near the tool. Then you spend five minutes matching starters to real kids, personalizing each one in your own words, in your own email. The tool made the blank page cheap; the sentence that lands is still yours. Today's lab takes one message start to finish, so the batch is homework with training wheels: the exact prompt is on your handout, and it's Send 2 on the First 48 Hours sheet.

SLIDE 12 **Practice: diagnose the message**

0:21

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her diagnosis eye: a bad message is a prompt missing a part. Role, Context, or Format: name it, fix it.

→ *Interactive. Read each sample, let the room name the missing formula part, confirm with the answer strip at the bottom of the slide. 45-min cut: samples 1 and 3 only.*

Quick practice, and it's really Kit 2 practice. When a message home goes wrong, it's usually because the prompt skipped part of the formula: Role, Task, Context, Format. So don't just call the symptom; diagnose which part got skipped. One: a 400-word newsletter where the field-trip permission slip sits in the last paragraph, so the key request is buried at the bottom. That's missing Format: the prompt never said "action items first, under 150 words." Two: a note that reads "formative assessment data indicates," sent to families. Missing Context: the prompt never said who's reading, families skimming on phones, plain words. Three: a message with three updates and nothing for families to do. Missing Format again: the prompt never asked for an action item with a date. Four: a perfectly polished email that sounds like a bank wrote it. Missing Role: the prompt never said "a warm teacher who sounds like me." The fix is never mysterious: hand the prompt the part it skipped, and run it again.

Segment 4 · Tone, and the lines that hold (slides 13–17)**SLIDE 13** **The tone-repair kit**

0:24

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her tone kit: 'warmer, shorter, plainer,' the read-aloud test, the 24-hour rule.

The tone-repair kit, small enough to memorize. Three commands fix ninety percent of drafts: warmer, shorter, plainer. One test catches the rest: read it aloud; your ear knows your voice better than your eyes do. And one rule protects your career: the 24-hour rule for anything written angry. That's the whole kit. It fits on the handout's back pocket and it will save you a hundred small regrets a year. Let's put it to work right now.

SLIDE 14 Practice: call the repair

0:26

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her repair calls: cold gets 'warmer,' rambling gets 'shorter,' jargon gets 'plainer.'

→ *Interactive. Read each draft, let the room call the command, then read the repaired line. 45-min cut: walk draft A only.*

Three real drafts, one command each; call it out. Draft A: "Reminder: the permission slip was due Monday. Students without one cannot attend." Every word is accurate and the whole thing lands like a citation. The call is warmer: "We're missing a few permission slips. Send yours back by tomorrow and everyone's on the bus." Draft B: sixty words of throat-clearing to say picture day is Friday. The call is shorter: "Picture day is Friday. Smiles optional, forms required." Draft C: "Our formative assessment data indicates additional at-home numeracy reinforcement would benefit your student." The call is plainer: "Your child is still working on multiplication. Ten minutes of practice at home this week would help." One command each, and notice how fast the repair comes back. That speed is why there's no excuse left for sending the cold version.

SLIDE 15 One red line: translation

0:28

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her red line: she writes it plain; she doesn't ship what she can't read.

One red line before the lab, and it's short. We do not use public AI tools to translate messages to families. Not because the tools are useless: because you cannot review what you cannot read, and nothing goes home with your name on it unreviewed. That rule doesn't bend for a language. Official and legal documents already have a lane, your district's translation channels; that's their obligation and their job. Your job is the original: plain language, short sentences, no idioms. A plain-language message is the version every family can actually use, including multilingual families, and it's the version district translators do their best work from. Write it plain; don't ship what you can't read.

SLIDE 16 The human-only list

0:29

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her human-only list: safety, discipline, grief, IEP news. She calls first.

And the line that never moves. Some news is never delivered by a draft: anything touching a child's safety, a serious discipline situation, a family's grief, or special-education decisions. For those, the technology is a telephone and the script is your own heart, first. A written follow-up can come later, and even then you write it yourself. If a message would change how a family sees their child, it deserves a human voice. No exceptions, and say so out loud to your staff, because this is the line that makes all the efficiency defensible.

SLIDE 17 What this builds

0:30

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her trust ledger: every reviewed, personal message is a deposit.

One beat on what all this builds. Every message home is a deposit in or a withdrawal from the only account that matters when something goes wrong: trust. Reviewed, personal, on-time messages, written plainly enough that every family can use them, are deposits. Late, generic, robotic ones are withdrawals. AI just made deposits cheap. The lab starts now.

Segment 5 · The lab: one real message (slides 18–23)

SLIDE 18 Lab setup

0:31

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lab plan: the Friday newsletter, from blank page to scheduled send.

→ *Dark slide. Devices out, pairs formed inside two minutes. Announce the tool.*

Lab time, eighteen minutes, one deliverable, completely real: the message you actually owe families this week, taken from blank page to scheduled send. Drafted, voiced, the hard part repaired, action items on top. Ms. Rivera is doing hers on screen, her Friday newsletter; you'll watch that same message evolve at every step, and yours evolves alongside it. Ground rules: no student information of any kind, no family names; describe situations, never people. Pair up; every message gets a second set of ears before it counts as done. Go.

SLIDE 19 Lab step 1: draft the real message

0:32

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her newsletter, v1: all four parts in. Beige, and the slip is at the bottom.

→ *6 minutes. Circulate. Weak drafts lack context; nudge with "what does a family actually need to know and do this week?" 45-min cut: 5 minutes.*

Step one, six minutes: draft it. The message you actually owe families: newsletter, unit update, event reminder, whatever is real. All four parts, and be generous with context: what happened, what's coming, what families need to do and by when. On screen, Ms. Rivera's first draft of her Friday newsletter, straight from the slide 9 prompt. Notice it's close, and notice it isn't her yet: "demonstrated excellent growth," "please be advised." And the permission slip, the one thing families must act on, sits in the last line. That's normal for a first draft. The next three steps are how it becomes hers.

SLIDE 20 Lab step 2: the voice pass

0:38

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her newsletter, v2: it sounds like her now. The slip is still buried.

→ *4 minutes. Pairs read their own drafts ALOUD; the partner's ear is the voice test. 45-min cut: fold step 4 in here: one read-aloud fixes voice and order together.*

Step two, four minutes, the voice pass. Read your draft aloud to your partner. Every sentence your mouth wouldn't say, retype it the way you'd say it, or ask for warmer, shorter, plainer. On screen, Ms. Rivera's v2 of the same newsletter: "demonstrated excellent growth" became "I was proud of how your kids stuck with the tricky parts." It sounds like her now. One thing is still wrong with it, and that's the next step.

SLIDE 21 Lab step 3: the hard sentence

0:42

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her newsletter, v3: the permission-slip nag rewritten warm, plain, and guilt-free.

→ 4 minutes. This is the deep-practice step; protect it. Circulate for the sentence people are avoiding.

Step three, four minutes: the hard sentence. Almost every real message carries one item you'd rather not write: the fee reminder, the missing slips, the gentle nag. Find yours and rewrite it warm, plain, and guilt-free, ending with exactly what to do and by when. Ms. Rivera's was the permission-slip line. Before: "Please be advised that students without a signed permission slip will be unable to participate." After: "If the blue slip hasn't made it home yet, no worries: it happens. Send it back by Wednesday so nobody misses out. Need a fresh copy? Just reply." Same requirement, zero sting, and the deadline still does its job. If your hard sentence came out a little angry, this is where the 24-hour rule gets its workout.

SLIDE 22 Lab step 4: the access pass & sign-off

0:46

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her newsletter, final: action items on top, under 150 words, scheduled for Friday at 3:00.

→ 4 minutes. Partners swap for the final read. 45-min cut: folded into step 2.

Last step, four minutes: the access pass, then the sign-off. Pull every action item to the top as a short list with dates. Plain words, under about 150. Then trade with your partner one last time: they read it as a tired parent on a phone at 9 p.m. and flag anything unclear. When it comes back clean, schedule the send: pick the day and the time right now. Ms. Rivera's final version: three bullets up top, slip first, warm paragraph after, scheduled for Friday at 3:00. That message is done, and done means it sends.

SLIDE 23 Share-out

0:50

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her share-out: v1's opening read against the final. Same facts; now it's her.

→ 3 voices, one minute each. 45-min cut: two voices.

Three voices, a minute each: read us your before and your after, the first draft against the version you just scheduled. Listen for how different the voices sound; that's the whole point. Same tool, thirty different teachers, thirty recognizable humans.

Segment 6 · Making it stick (slides 24–27)

SLIDE 24 What you just built

0:53

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her inventory: newsletter scheduled; batch prompt queued; 24-hour rule armed.

The inventory, eighteen minutes of work: next week's real message, drafted, voiced, the hard sentence repaired, action items on top, and scheduled to send. Plus two habits ready to start: the positive-note batch, whose prompt is on your handout and whose first run is Send 2 on the First 48 Hours sheet, and the 24-hour rule for anything written angry. One message, start to finish, and nothing about it was hypothetical.

SLIDE 25 Honest limits

0:54

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her honest limits: AI can't know the family or repair trust it didn't build.

Honest limits, as always. The tool doesn't know your families, their histories, or what last year did to their trust in schools; you do, and personalizing is where that knowledge enters. The tool also sounds fluent in every language, and that's exactly why translation stays off your desk: fluent-sounding and faithful are different things, and you can't check the difference in a language you don't read. And no tool repairs trust; only consistency does. AI lowers the cost of consistency. That's its whole contribution, and it's a big one.

SLIDE 26 Our three commitments

0:54

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her commitments: review and personalize everything; call first on hard news; one batch a week.

Three commitments, same drill as every kit. One: every AI-drafted message is reviewed and personalized before it sends; families hear me, not the tool. Two: hard news travels by voice first, mine, every time. Three: one positive-note batch a week; the one-sentence habit the research validated. Can I get a nod on those three?

SLIDE 27 Where this goes

0:55

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her month: batch habit, a makeover swap, comms templates in the staff doc.

The month ahead, all inside existing PLC time: week two, a batch check-in, who sent their three notes and what came back; week three, the message-makeover swap, bring the month's hardest message and repair it together with the tone kit; week four, the best message templates go in the staff doc's new Communication section. Nobody at this school writes the field-trip reminder from scratch again.

Close (slides 28–30)

SLIDE 28 First 48 hours

0:56

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her 48 hours: the newsletter sends Friday; the batch runs Monday; the hard reply finally goes.

First 48 Hours sheet, three actions: let the message you scheduled today send on time, it's done, let it be done; run the batch prompt from the handout, pick three starters, personalize and send them; and send the reply you've been sitting on, the one in your inbox right now, with the tool absorbing the heat and the 24-hour rule setting the clock. Three sends, and this PD becomes something families actually felt.

SLIDE 29 Exit ticket

0:57

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her exit ticket: what she drafted, her note-batch plan, one worry.

Exit tickets at the door: what you drafted, your note-batch plan, and the communication situation you still want help with. Those situations set the agenda for the follow-ups, so be specific.

SLIDE 30 **Close**

0:57

Last word. Nobody remembers a beige newsletter, and nobody forgets the teacher who sent home one true sentence about their kid. The tool writes drafts now. The sentences families keep are still yours. Next session, Kit 7, we go after the workload itself: finding each of you the best saved hour in your week. Thanks for the hour. Go send something worth keeping.

© Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi · AI-Ready School. Licensed for use within the purchasing school. This resource is provided for informational purposes by educators, not attorneys, and is not legal advice. Consult your district's legal counsel before adopting any policy. Third-party tools are referenced factually; no endorsement implied.